PREP-RASHAN

A Unit of Prep-Rashan Tutorial

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS - RASHAN

Answers, Explanations & Elimination Techniques – 20 MCQs

13 November 2026

How to use: For each question you get the correct answer, the concept being tested, a check of every statement or pair, why each of the four options is right or wrong, and four ways to eliminate wrong options – logic, keywords, factual clues and conceptual understanding.

GS-I: General Studies Paper I

Q1. [GS-I | Kurumba community]

With reference to the Kurumba community of Kerala, consider the following statements:

1. They are classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group.
2. The Kurumba language has its own script.
3. The Kurumba language belongs to the Dravidian family.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: The Kurumbas of Attappady (Palakkad) are one of Kerala's five PVTGs. Their language, Kurumba, belongs to the Southern Dravidian branch and is purely oral, with no script of its own. The SPPEL scheme of the Central Institute of Indian Languages lists it for documentation.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – it is an oral language with no script.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

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Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Most small tribal languages are oral – a script would make it far less endangered.
- **Keywords:** PVTG; oral; Southern Dravidian.
- **Factual clue:** Population only 2,719 (2024).
- **Conceptual understanding:** Endangered oral languages.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every Indian language has a script.
Remember: Kurumba: Dravidian, oral, no script.

Q2. [GS-I | Buxa Tiger Reserve]

Buxa Tiger Reserve shares an international border with:

(a) Nepal
(b) Bhutan
(c) Bangladesh
(d) Myanmar

ANSWER: (b) Bhutan

Concept behind the question: Buxa Tiger Reserve lies in Alipurduar district of northern West Bengal, in the Terai–Dooars. The Sinchula range on the Bhutan border bounds it to the north, and Assam lies to the east. It became India's 15th Tiger Reserve in 1983.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Nepal* — Wrong – Nepal lies further west.
(b)	*Bhutan* — **Correct – Bhutan to the north.**
(c)	*Bangladesh* — Wrong.
(d)	*Myanmar* — Wrong.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Dooars' means the doors or passes into Bhutan – a direct clue.
- **Keywords:** Buxa → Alipurduar → Bhutan border.
- **Factual clue:** Rivers Sankosh and Raidak flow in from Bhutan.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Locating protected areas.

Trap to avoid: Picking Bangladesh because the reserve is in West Bengal.
Remember: Buxa TR borders Bhutan.

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Q3. [GS-I | Census and small languages]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: In the Census, languages with fewer than 10,000 speakers are grouped under 'Others'.

Statement-II: Kurumba is one of the languages listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect

Concept behind the question: The Census groups languages with fewer than 10,000 speakers under 'Others', which lowers their visibility. Kurumba, spoken by a few thousand people, is not an Eighth Schedule language; it is an endangered oral tribal language targeted for documentation under SPPEL.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement-I	Correct.
✘ Statement-II	Wrong – it is not in the Eighth Schedule.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — **Correct – I true, II false.**
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A language spoken by a few thousand people, now endangered, is unlikely to be a scheduled language.
- **Keywords:** 'Others' below 10,000; Kurumba not scheduled.
- **Factual clue:** The Eighth Schedule lists 22 languages.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Visibility of small languages.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every tribal language is in the Eighth Schedule.
Remember: Kurumba is not an Eighth Schedule language.

GS-II: General Studies Paper II

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Q4. [GS-II | Hindu Succession Act – Class I heirs]

Under Section 8 of the 1956 Hindu Succession Act, which one of the following is NOT a Class I heir of a Hindu male?

(a) Daughter
(b) Widow
(c) Son of a predeceased son
(d) Son of a living son

ANSWER: (d) Son of a living son

Concept behind the question: Class I heirs include sons, daughters, the widow, the mother and the son of a predeceased son. The son of a living son is not a Class I heir. So, as the Supreme Court held, a grandson cannot claim his grandfather's property under Section 8 while his own father is alive.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Daughter* — Wrong – a Class I heir.
(b)	*Widow* — Wrong – a Class I heir.
(c)	*Son of a predeceased son* — Wrong – a Class I heir.
(d)	*Son of a living son* — **Correct – not a Class I heir.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** When the father is alive, he himself inherits; the grandson's claim comes only through him.
- **Keywords:** Predeceased son's son – yes; living son's son – no.
- **Factual clue:** Section 19: heirs hold as tenants in common.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Order of succession.

Trap to avoid: Confusing 'predeceased' with 'living'.
Remember: Son of a living son is not a Class I heir.

Q5. [GS-II | Schools of Hindu law]

Consider the following statements regarding Hindu law of inheritance:

1. Under the Mitakshara school, a son is traditionally entitled by birth to an interest in ancestral coparcenary property.
2. The Dayabhaga school is followed mainly in West Bengal and Assam.
3. Under Section 19 of the 1956 Hindu Succession Act, heirs who inherit together hold the property as joint tenants.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

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ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: Mitakshara (most of India) gives a son an interest by birth in ancestral coparcenary property; Dayabhaga (mainly West Bengal and Assam) gives no right by birth – inheritance opens only on the father's death. Section 19 says co-heirs hold as tenants in common, each with a separate share, not as joint tenants.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – tenants in common.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct; 3 is not.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The Court's ruling rested on each heir becoming the separate owner of a share – that is tenancy in common, not joint tenancy.
- **Keywords:** Mitakshara – by birth; Dayabhaga – WB, Assam; Sec 19 – tenants in common.
- **Factual clue:** Sale by the father was upheld.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Schools of Hindu law.

Trap to avoid: Mixing up joint tenancy and tenancy in common.
Remember: Sec 19: tenants in common – separate shares.

Q6. [GS-II | India–Bangladesh water sharing]

The Ganga Water Treaty between India and Bangladesh relates to sharing of water at:

(a) Tipaimukh
(b) Teesta Barrage
(c) Bhagalpur
(d) Farakka

ANSWER: (d) Farakka

Concept behind the question: The 1996 Ganga Water Treaty governs sharing of the Ganga's lean-season flow at the Farakka Barrage. It is due to expire in 2026, and renewal talks have slowed amid strains over Sheikh Hasina's planned return to Bangladesh.

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Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Tipaimukh* — Wrong – a proposed dam on the Barak.
(b)	*Teesta Barrage* — Wrong – the Teesta deal is still pending.
(c)	*Bhagalpur* — Wrong.
(d)	*Farakka* — **Correct – Farakka.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The Teesta deal has never been signed, so it cannot be the treaty in force.
- **Keywords:** Ganga Treaty 1996 → Farakka.
- **Factual clue:** Due to expire in 2026.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Water diplomacy.

Trap to avoid: Choosing Teesta, which is often in the news.
Remember: Ganga Water Treaty = Farakka.

Q7. [GS-II | East Asia Summit]

With reference to the East Asia Summit (EAS), consider the following statements:

1. It has 19 members.
2. Its first summit was held in Kuala Lumpur.
3. The United States is not a member.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: The EAS was set up in 2005, with its first summit in Kuala Lumpur. Its 19 members are the 11 ASEAN states plus Australia, China, India, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, Russia and the United States. The 21st EAS is in Manila in November 2026.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Statement 1**	Correct.
✔ **Statement 2**	Correct.
✘ **Statement 3**	Wrong – the US is a member.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**

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(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The EAS is the main leaders' forum of the Indo-Pacific – it includes both the US and Russia.
- **Keywords:** 19 members; Kuala Lumpur 2005; US and Russia in.
- **Factual clue:** Singapore hosts in 2027.
- **Conceptual understanding:** ASEAN-led forums.

Trap to avoid: Thinking the EAS is an Asian-only body.
Remember: EAS: 19 members including the US and Russia.

Q8. [GS-II | Tuberculosis in India]

With reference to tuberculosis (TB) in India, consider the following statements:

1. India's TB deaths fell by about 38% between 2015 and 2025.
2. Most of India's national TB programme is funded by foreign donors.
3. The Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana gives nutrition support to TB patients through Direct Benefit Transfer.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: India recorded 2.63 lakh TB deaths in 2025 – a 38% fall since 2015, better than the global 35%. About 96% of the programme's funds come from India's own budget. The Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana pays a monthly nutrition support through DBT.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Statement 1**	Correct.
✘ **Statement 2**	Wrong – about 96% is domestic.
✔ **Statement 3**	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

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How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The report praised India's 'sovereign commitment' – the money is domestic.
- **Keywords:** –38% deaths; 96% domestic; NPY DBT.
- **Factual clue:** 94% treatment success rate.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Health financing.

Trap to avoid: Assuming a disease programme in a developing country depends on donors.
Remember: India's TB programme: ~96% domestic funding.

Q9. [GS-II | KVS digital initiatives]

The 'Samiksha AI Bot', recently in the news, is part of:

(a) DIKSHA
(b) SWAYAM
(c) PM eVidya
(d) KVS Vidya Samiksha Kendra

ANSWER: (d) KVS Vidya Samiksha Kendra

Concept behind the question: The Ministry of Education launched three KVS platforms: the AI-integrated Vidya Samiksha Kendra (with the Samiksha AI Bot that spots learning and admin gaps), the KVS-Samvaad Parent Connect app and portal, and the KVS Alumni Connect Portal. They were built in-house by the IT Services Cell of KVS headquarters.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*DIKSHA* — Wrong – a digital learning platform.
(b)	*SWAYAM* — Wrong – an online course platform.
(c)	*PM eVidya* — Wrong – a school e-learning programme.
(d)	*KVS Vidya Samiksha Kendra* — **Correct – KVS VSK.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Samiksha' (review) matches the 'Vidya Samiksha Kendra' – the review centre.
- **Keywords:** Samiksha AI Bot → VSK (KVS).
- **Factual clue:** KVS-Samvaad for parents.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Data-driven school governance.

Trap to avoid: Picking DIKSHA because it is the best-known platform.
Remember: Samiksha AI Bot = KVS Vidya Samiksha Kendra.

GS-III: General Studies Paper III

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Q10. [GS-III | Siang river]

The Siang river of Arunachal Pradesh is known in Tibet as the:

(a) Yarlung Tsangpo
(b) Sutlej
(c) Indus
(d) Manas

ANSWER: (a) Yarlung Tsangpo

Concept behind the question: The Siang is the Indian stretch of the Yarlung Tsangpo, which becomes the Brahmaputra in Assam. The Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (about 11,000 MW) is planned on it partly as a buffer against China's proposed 60,000-MW Medog dam upstream.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Yarlung Tsangpo* — **Correct – Yarlung Tsangpo.**
(b)	*Sutlej* — Wrong – enters India in Himachal Pradesh.
(c)	*Indus* — Wrong – flows through Ladakh.
(d)	*Manas* — Wrong – a Bhutan–Assam river.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Only one of these rivers enters India through Arunachal Pradesh.
- **Keywords:** Yarlung Tsangpo → Siang → Brahmaputra.
- **Factual clue:** SUMP: NHPC, PFR stage.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Transboundary rivers.

Trap to avoid: Choosing the Indus or Sutlej because they also rise in Tibet.
Remember: Siang = Yarlung Tsangpo.

Q11. [GS-III | Dam safety in the Himalaya]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: The site of the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project lies in a region of Seismic Zone V.

Statement-II: Reservoir-induced seismicity refers to earthquakes triggered by the weight and seepage of a large reservoir.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I

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Concept behind the question: The eastern Himalaya, where SUMP is planned, falls in Seismic Zone V – the highest risk zone. Reservoir-induced seismicity is a separate idea: large reservoirs can trigger quakes. Both are true, but II does not explain why the area is in Zone V – that is due to tectonics, not reservoirs.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Statement-I**	Correct.
✔ **Statement-II**	Correct – but it does not explain I.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — Wrong – II does not explain I.
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — **Correct – both true, no causal link.**
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — Wrong – II is also correct.
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The region is in Zone V because of plate tectonics; no dam exists yet to cause quakes.
- **Keywords:** Zone V – tectonics; RIS – reservoirs.
- **Factual clue:** GLOF risk also flagged.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Disaster risk in hydropower.

Trap to avoid: Marking (a) because both are about earthquakes.
Remember: Both true; reservoirs do not explain Zone V.

Q12. [GS-III | COP31 – climate finance]

The goal of mobilising US$300 billion a year for developing countries by 2035 was agreed at:

(a) COP27, Sharm el-Sheikh
(b) COP28, Dubai
(c) COP29, Baku
(d) COP30, Belém

ANSWER: (c) COP29, Baku

Concept behind the question: The New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) of $300 billion a year by 2035 was agreed at COP29 in Baku. COP31 in Antalya, Türkiye, aims to advance its delivery, along with COP30's call to triple adaptation finance by 2035.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*COP27, Sharm el-Sheikh* — Wrong – set up the loss-and-damage fund idea.
(b)	*COP28, Dubai* — Wrong – the first global stocktake.
(c)	*COP29, Baku* — **Correct – Baku.**

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(d)	*COP30, Belém* — Wrong – called for tripling adaptation finance.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The finance COP was Baku; COP30 added the adaptation-tripling call.
- **Keywords:** NCQG $300 bn → COP29 Baku.
- **Factual clue:** COP31: Antalya, Türkiye.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Climate finance goals.

Trap to avoid: Picking COP30 because it is the most recent before COP31.
Remember: $300 bn by 2035 = COP29, Baku.

Q13. [GS-III | PM-SETU]

PM-SETU, recently in the news, aims to:

(a) Upgrade government ITIs through industry-led hubs and spokes
(b) Build rural bridges and roads
(c) Set up solar parks on wasteland
(d) Fund green hydrogen start-ups

ANSWER: (a) Upgrade government ITIs through industry-led hubs and spokes

Concept behind the question: PM-SETU (Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs) is a ₹60,000-crore scheme that will modernise 1,000 government ITIs, organised as 200 hubs with 800 spokes and run with industry partners, adding labs and courses in green technology, AI and EVs.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Upgrade government ITIs through industry-led hubs and spokes* — **Correct.**
(b)	*Build rural bridges and roads* — Wrong.
(c)	*Set up solar parks on wasteland* — Wrong.
(d)	*Fund green hydrogen start-ups* — Wrong.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Upgraded ITIs' is in the full name itself.
- **Keywords:** PM-SETU → 1,000 ITIs, ₹60,000 crore.
- **Factual clue:** Green jobs could reach 1.3 crore by 2035.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Skilling for green jobs.

Trap to avoid: Reading 'SETU' (bridge) literally.
Remember: PM-SETU = ITI upgrade scheme.

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Q14. [GS-III | Retail inflation]

Consider the following statements:

1. The new Consumer Price Index series uses 2024 as its base year.
2. The inflation target under the RBI Act is 4% with a tolerance band of 2–6%.
3. The Consumer Price Index is compiled by the Reserve Bank of India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: The new CPI (base 2024 = 100) is compiled monthly by the National Statistics Office under MoSPI. Under Section 45ZA of the RBI Act, the Government, in consultation with the RBI, sets a 4% target with a 2–6% band. Inflation reached 6.09% in October 2026.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – the NSO, MoSPI.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct; 3 is not.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The RBI uses the CPI but does not compile it – statistics come from MoSPI.
- **Keywords:** Base 2024; 4% ± 2; NSO.
- **Factual clue:** Food weight about 36.75%.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Inflation targeting.

Trap to avoid: Assuming the RBI compiles the index it targets.
Remember: CPI = NSO (MoSPI); target set under Sec 45ZA.

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Q15. [GS-III | Inflation targeting]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: If inflation stays outside the tolerance band for three consecutive quarters, the RBI must explain the failure and propose corrective steps.

Statement-II: The inflation target is fixed by the RBI on its own, without the Government.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I

(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I

(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect

(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect

Concept behind the question: Under the flexible inflation targeting framework, a breach for three consecutive quarters requires the RBI to report the reasons, remedies and a timeline. But the target itself is set by the Government in consultation with the RBI under Section 45ZA – not by the RBI alone.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement-I	Correct.
✘ Statement-II	Wrong – the Government sets it, in consultation with the RBI.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — **Correct – I true, II false.**
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The RBI is accountable for meeting a target someone else sets – that is why it must explain a breach.
- **Keywords:** Target – Government; delivery – RBI/MPC.
- **Factual clue:** Six-member MPC sets the repo rate.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Accountability in monetary policy.

Trap to avoid: Thinking the central bank sets its own target.
Remember: Government sets the target; the RBI must meet it.

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Q16. [GS-III | Pioxaniliprole]

Pioxaniliprole, recently approved in India, acts on insects by targeting:

(a) Acetylcholinesterase
(b) Ryanodine receptors
(c) Chitin synthesis
(d) Sodium channels

ANSWER: (b) Ryanodine receptors

Concept behind the question: Pioxaniliprole, India's first indigenously discovered insecticide molecule (PI Industries), is an anthranilic diamide. It switches on ryanodine receptors in insect muscle, causing an uncontrolled release of calcium, which leads to feeding stop, paralysis and death.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Acetylcholinesterase* — Wrong – targeted by organophosphates.
(b)	*Ryanodine receptors* — **Correct – ryanodine receptors.**
(c)	*Chitin synthesis* — Wrong – targeted by growth regulators.
(d)	*Sodium channels* — Wrong – targeted by pyrethroids.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Diamide insecticides are known for acting on ryanodine receptors.
- **Keywords:** Diamide → RyR → calcium release.
- **Factual clue:** Approved by CIBRC for rice, chilli, tomato, chana.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Modes of action.

Trap to avoid: Choosing acetylcholinesterase, the classic insecticide target.
Remember: Pioxaniliprole acts on ryanodine receptors.

Q17. [GS-III | Rattlepod]

With reference to rattlepod (Crotalaria retusa), consider the following statements:

1. It belongs to the legume family.
2. It fixes atmospheric nitrogen through root nodules.
3. Its seeds are safe for livestock and poultry.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

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Concept behind the question: Rattlepod is a legume (Fabaceae) that fixes nitrogen through root nodules and is used as green manure. But it contains toxic pyrrolizidine alkaloids, especially in the seeds, which can poison livestock and poultry. Its mass bloom turned the Yellapatty grasslands near Munnar golden.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – the seeds are toxic.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct; 3 is not.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The plant's alkaloids defend it against grazers – so it cannot be safe fodder.
- **Keywords:** Legume; fixes N; toxic seeds.
- **Factual clue:** Blue Tiger butterflies use its alkaloids.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Plant chemical defence.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every legume is good fodder.
Remember: Rattlepod seeds are toxic to livestock.

Q18. [GS-III | Tiger reserves]

Consider the following pairs (Tiger Reserve : State):

	Tiger Reserve	State
1.	Nawegaon-Nagzira	Maharashtra
2.	Buxa	West Bengal
3.	Kanha	Chhattisgarh

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

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Concept behind the question: Nawegaon-Nagzira (Gondia and Bhandara) is India's 46th Tiger Reserve and Maharashtra's 5th. Buxa is in Alipurduar, West Bengal. Kanha is in Madhya Pradesh – it is linked to Nawegaon-Nagzira along with Pench, Tadoba-Andhari and Indravati (Chhattisgarh).

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Pair 1	Correct.
✔ Pair 2	Correct.
✘ Pair 3	Wrong – Kanha is in Madhya Pradesh.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – pairs 1 and 2.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – pair 3 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Indravati is the Chhattisgarh reserve in this network; Kanha is in Madhya Pradesh.
- **Keywords:** NNTR – MH; Buxa – WB; Kanha – MP.
- **Factual clue:** NNTR's highest point: Zenda Pahad (702 m).
- **Conceptual understanding:** Central Indian tiger landscape.

Trap to avoid: Mixing up Kanha with Indravati.
Remember: Kanha is in Madhya Pradesh.

Q19. [GS-III | Karakoram-2026]

'Karakoram-2026', recently in the news, was a joint military exercise between:

(a) India and Nepal
(b) Pakistan and Türkiye
(c) China and Russia
(d) China and Pakistan

ANSWER: (d) China and Pakistan

Concept behind the question: Karakoram-2026 was the first China–Pakistan joint exercise with regular army formations, held in Xinjiang near Ladakh. It built on earlier drills – Warrior (counter-terrorism), Sea Guardian (navy) and Shaheen (air force).

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*India and Nepal* — Wrong.
(b)	*Pakistan and Türkiye* — Wrong.
(c)	*China and Russia* — Wrong.
(d)	*China and Pakistan* — **Correct – China and Pakistan.**

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How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The Karakoram range lies between China and Pakistan-occupied areas – a geographic clue.
- **Keywords:** Karakoram-2026 → China–Pakistan, Xinjiang.
- **Factual clue:** Mixed combat teams; Chinese weapons.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Two-front challenge.

Trap to avoid: Guessing India–Nepal from the mountain name.
Remember: Karakoram-2026 = China–Pakistan.

GS-IV: General Studies Paper IV

Q20. [GS-IV | Ethics – consent in development]

As District Collector, you learn that villagers signed consent forms for a dam survey after being told their welfare benefits might stop. What is the most appropriate course of action?

(a) Treat the signatures as valid, since the forms are signed
(b) Proceed with the survey but promise compensation later
(c) Leave the matter to the project agency
(d) Declare the consent void, stop the coercion and hold fresh, open Gram Sabha consultations

ANSWER: (d) Declare the consent void, stop the coercion and hold fresh, open Gram Sabha consultations

Concept behind the question: Consent given under threat is not real consent. The Collector must stop the coercion, treat the forms as void and seek free, prior and informed consent through open Gram Sabha meetings with full information on risks and benefits. This protects rights and rebuilds trust.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Treat the signatures as valid, since the forms are signed* — Wrong – signatures under threat are not consent.
(b)	*Proceed with the survey but promise compensation later* — Wrong – builds on a tainted process.
(c)	*Leave the matter to the project agency* — Wrong – abdicates responsibility.
(d)	*Declare the consent void, stop the coercion and hold fresh, open Gram Sabha consultations* — **Correct – fair process and real consent.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Drop options that accept, build on or ignore coerced consent; choose the one that restores a fair process.
- **Keywords:** Free, prior, informed consent.
- **Factual clue:** Consent for a survey is not consent for a dam.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Procedural justice.

Trap to avoid: Treating a signature as proof of consent.
Remember: Coerced consent is void – restart with FPIC.

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ANSWER KEY

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
(c)	(b)	(c)	(d)	(a)	(d)	(b)	(c)	(d)	(a)
Q11	**Q12**	**Q13**	**Q14**	**Q15**	**Q16**	**Q17**	**Q18**	**Q19**	**Q20**
(b)	(c)	(a)	(a)	(c)	(b)	(a)	(b)	(d)	(d)

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